

ARE

PEOPLE BORN EVIL?

It is tempting to think that a brutal serial killer or monstrous person, such as German dictator Adolf Hitler (1889–1945), must have been born evil. But can a baby really be evil? We all have the capacity to do harm, just as we all have the capacity to do good. Many psychiatrists hesitate to call anyone evil—the factors that turn some people into murderers or criminals are complex, involving their life experiences as well as the makeup of their brains.

AND DO ANGELS EXIST?

Angels are invisible spirits but are often depicted in human form with long feathery wings. They are thought to be messengers sent by God to protect humans and prevent them from doing harm. No one can prove they exist, so whether you believe in them or not depends on your point of view. However, in 2005, 79 percent of people who responded to an American Internet poll said that they believed they had a guardian angel. Heavenly!

HOW ABOUT DEVILS?

These bad boys are demons or supernatural creatures that harm humans and encourage them to do bad things. Devils are found in most cultures and religions. In the Jewish and Christian Bible, the devil is called Satan, which means “enemy.” Some people believe that he really exists, but others think that the devil is just a symbol of evil. For many people, devils are simply comedy figures with horns, a tail, and a pitchfork seen at Halloween. Trick or treat, anyone?

